



Clyde Cessna with the Cessna Comet outside his first factory in Wichita, Kansas, 1917

Great Manufacturers Cessna

Cessna Aircraft Company has sold more aircraft than any other company in history. Since its founding in 1927 it has delivered an astonishing 193,500 aircraft, ranging from light trainers to military jets. Today it remains one of the biggest sellers of business jets around the world.

THE STORY OF CESSNA Aircraft began in June 1911, when 30-year-old Clyde V. Cessna, a farmer-mechanic, built his first aircraft. This was a Blériot-type monoplane powered by a 60 hp Elbridge engine, and when Cessna took the aircraft on his first successful flight he became the first person to build and fly an airplane west of the Mississippi and east of the Rocky Mountains. In 1925 Cessna joined forces with two other great names in American aviation, Walter Beech and Lloyd Stearman, to form the Travel Air Manufacturing



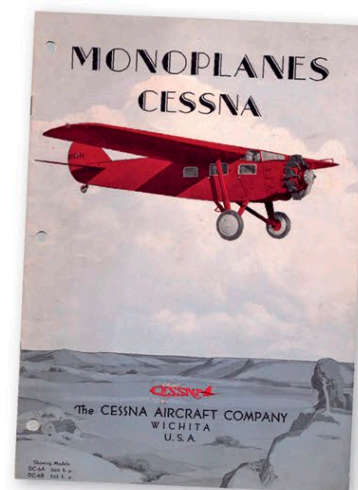
Clyde Cessna
(1879-1954)

Company. The firm quickly gained a reputation for building excellent biplanes, but Cessna was more interested in monoplanes and left to set up the Cessna-Roos Aircraft Company with Victor Roos in September 1927. However, they soon parted company, and on the last day of 1927 Cessna formed the Cessna Aircraft Company.

The first Cessna aircraft to enter series production was a clean-looking high-wing monoplane, powered by a single piston engine. Several successful designs followed, but ironically, a

particularly promising machine, the Cessna DC-6, was certified on October 29, 1929—the day the Wall Street stock market crashed. Cessna suspended aircraft production from 1932 to 1934 before business slowly began to recover.

Clyde Cessna retired in 1936, selling his share of the company to a nephew, Dwayne Wallace. Like many US aircraft manufacturers, the business received a boost in 1940 as America began to rearm. The company received its biggest order to date, when the USAAC requested 33 T-50 light twins. The RCAF later ordered a further 180 T-50s.



Early Cessna catalog

Because of the Wall Street Crash of 1929, only a few of the DC-6, shown on the cover of this catalog, were produced.



Cessna 140

The Cessna 140 was a two-seat aircraft produced from 1947-51. It was followed by the Cessna 150, which had one of the highest production runs of any civilian aircraft.